

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Red, the color of love!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What is your favorite color? Do you have a reason?
- What do some colors mean to you?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about culture and traditions.
- I can talk about someone's feelings and reactions.
- I can speculate about feelings and impressions.





Let's Explore!

In this article, Sally talks about what different colors **symbolize***.

* When something "*symbolizes*" something, it acts as a *symbol* for something, like a certain meaning or idea.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

All over the world, the colors red, yellow, and green on traffic lights have the same meaning: stop, caution, and go. In different countries, these colors may mean different things.

In China, the color red is the sign of happiness and joy, whereas in Europe it may mean anger. Yellow was the color of happiness in ancient Egypt, but in Europe and North America, a "yellow" person is a coward, which can't be a good thing. The color green must have meant power in Egypt, but it is the color of youth in Japan. A new worker or new immigrant is called "green" in some countries, but in North America jealousy is called the "green-eyed monster."

The different meaning of colors in different countries and cultures has developed over time. However, studies show that human beings everywhere react to certain colors in similar ways. For example, people seem to get excited when exposed to red light and feel subdued when exposed to blue light. Pink is closer to red than blue, but it seems to be the most calming color of all.





Let's Practice!

What did the editor learn in Sally's article?

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Write the correct color red, yellow, or green. Practice saying the sentences aloud with a partner. Correct each other.

Happiness in China. _____.

New worker. _____.

Jealousy in North America. _____.

A coward in North America. _____.

Anger. _____.

Happiness in Egypt. _____.

Power in Egypt. _____.

Youth in Japan. _____.



Let's Practice!

Let's look at how people react to colors.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the corresponding adjective correctly (-ed or -ing), for each sentence. Use words from the box below. Practice saying the sentences aloud with a partner. Correct each other.

interested

excited

annoyed

calmed

subdued

interesting

exciting

annoying

calming

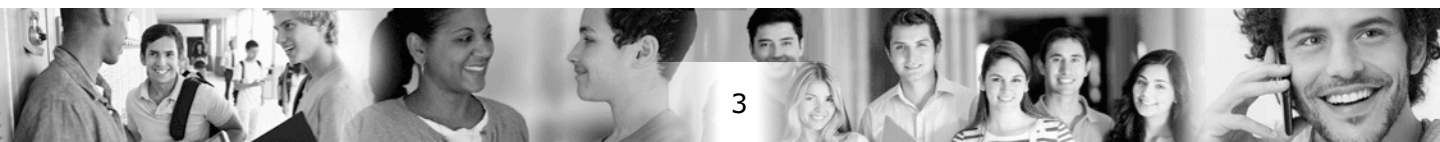
subduing

Do you find the subjects of colors _____?

People seem to get _____ when exposed to red light and feel _____ when exposed to blue light.

Pink seems to be the most _____ color of all.

Red is the color of happiness, but it makes me feel _____.





Extension Activity

Find out more about what different colors mean in different countries.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose 5 colors.
- With a partner, discuss what things each color may symbolize for you or for other people.
- Write down the meanings you found for each color.
- Share your list.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I discuss cultures and traditions in relation to colors.

☐ ☐

I read about the meaning of colors in different places.

☐ ☐

I share the information.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **happiness** (noun): the state of being happy or content
e.g. Yellow was the color of happiness in ancient Egypt.
- **joy** (noun): the feeling of great happiness
e.g. In China, the color red is the sign of happiness and joy.
- **coward** (noun): a person who is constantly afraid
e.g. In Europe and North America, a "yellow" person is a coward.
- **calming** (adjective): describes something that brings peace and calm
e.g. Pink seems to be the most calming color of all.
- **jealousy** (noun): the feeling that you envy what someone else has
e.g. In North America, jealousy is called the "green-eyed monster."
- **subdued** (adjective): calm; peaceful
e.g. People seem to get excited when exposed to red light and feel subdued when exposed to blue light.
- **anger** (noun): the feeling of being angry or mad
e.g. In Europe the color red means anger.
- **power** (noun): the ability to decide things and make things happen
e.g. The color green meant power in Egypt.





Learning Points

Speculating about Feelings and Impressions

When you speculate about something, you are making a guess based on what you know about the situation.

You can show you are speculating about something by using a modal, like *must* or *can't*.

When the modal verb *must* is followed by *have* + a verb in the past participle form, we are referring to a past action.

Examples:

- *The color green must have meant power in Egypt, but it is the color of youth in Japan.*
- *In Europe and North America, a "yellow" person is a coward, which can't be a good thing.*

Talking About Someone's Feelings and Reactions

You talk about feelings and reactions using adjectives.

Adjectives that end in **-ed** are used to describe how a person feels, like *excited*, *subdued*, *distressed*, *surprised*, *bored*, *worried* or *tired*.

Adjectives that end in **-ing** are used to describe things and situations, like *exciting*, *subduing*, *distracting*, *distressing*, *boring*, *worrying* or *tiring*.

These adjectives describe the *effect* something has on a person.

Examples:

- *People seem to get excited when exposed to red light and feel subdued when exposed to blue light.*
- *Pink seems to be the most calming color of all.*

